

Luna Fazio

Espoo, Finland

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Education

TU Dortmund, Department of Statistics

PH.D. IN STATISTICS

- Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Paul-Christian Bürkner
- Research project: Bayesian distributional latent variable models

Dortmund, Germany

2022 – Estimated 2026

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú

M.Sc. IN STATISTICS

- Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Giancarlo Sal Y Rosas
- Thesis: Endpoint-inflated beta-binomial regression for correlated count data.

Lima, Peru

2017 – 2021

Universidad Peruana Cayetano Heredia

B.Sc. IN BIOLOGY

Lima, Peru

2010 – 2015

Work experience

Institute for Replication

RESEARCH SCIENTIST

- Reproduction of scientific papers published in leading psychology and public health journals

Remote

2026 – Present

Jacobs Foundation

CONSULTANT

- Development of guidelines and software for prior elicitation in models of large scale interventions for child development

Remote

2025

TU Dortmund, Department of Statistics

RESEARCH ASSOCIATE

- Supervised by Prof. Dr. Paul Bürkner (DFG Project 497785967)
- Research on specification of complex latent variable models with applications in cognitive modeling

Dortmund, Germany

2023 – 2025

University of Stuttgart

RESEARCH ASSOCIATE

- Supervised by Prof. Dr. Paul Bürkner (DFG Project 497785967)
- Research on extensions to the Structural Equation Modeling framework

Stuttgart, Germany

2022 – 2023

Bernard van Leer Foundation

CONSULTANT

- Design and development of a web-based application for monitoring of public health interventions
- Developed Shiny and Tableau-based dashboards for data processing and visualization

Lima, Peru

2021 – 2022

Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit – Peru

CONSULTANT

- Developed Tableau dashboards to monitor key indicators of municipality-level performance

Lima, Peru

2020

Delivery Unit – Presidencia del Consejo de Ministros

ANALYST

- Monitoring of key government interventions through survey and administrative data
- Technical assistance for the procurement of impact evaluation and data collection services.

Lima, Peru

2019 – 2020

UNICEF

CONSULTANT

- Conducted a literature review on measurement of adolescent well-being
- Assisted in the design and estimation of an index for adolescent well-being

Lima, Peru

2018 – 2019

Ministerio de Salud

ANALYST

- Design and measurement of health indicators for various national interventions

Lima, Peru

2016 – 2018

Centro de Investigación Interdisciplinaria en Sexualidad, Sida y Sociedad

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

- Monitoring and analysis of longitudinal studies
- Provided statistical support to fellow researchers

Lima, Peru

2015 – 2016

- Data collection tasks involving healthcare personnel and patients
- Provided training and monitoring of field data collection via mobile apps
- Data processing and statistical analysis

Institute for Molecular Pathology

Vienna, Austria

- Collection and analysis of two-photon microscope data on synapse dynamics in mouse cortex

Publications

Fazio L, Bürkner PC. *Latent Variable Models for Distributional Features* Available as arXiv preprint, 2025.

Fazio L, Scholz M, Aguilar JE, Bürkner PC. *Primed Priors for Simulation-Based Validation of Bayesian Models*. In review (available as arXiv preprint), 2025.

Fazio L, Bürkner PC. *Gaussian Distributional Structural Equation Models: A framework for modeling latent heteroscedasticity*. Multivariate Behavioral Research, 2025.

Allan-Blitz LT, Konda KA, Vargas SK, Wang X, Segura ER, **Fazio L**, Calvo GM, Caceres CF, Klausner JD. *The Development of an Online Risk Calculator for the Prediction of Future Syphilis among a High-Risk Cohort of Men Who Have Sex with Men and Transgender Women in Lima, Peru*. Sexual Health, 2018.

García PJ, **Fazio L**, Bayer AM, Lizarraga AG, Chiappe M, La Rosa S, Lazo M, López L, Valderrama M, Cárcamo CP. *Sexual health knowledge and practices and STI/HIV prevalence among long-distance truck drivers in Peru*. SAGE Open Medicine, 2017.

Egoavil MS, Condor DF, Pinazo-Vidal MA, Quezada JM, **Fazio L**, Bueno JC, Peña LE, Farfán J, De la Puente JG, Arce C, Malpartida B, Arostegui A, Pérez-Lu JE. *Qualitative Study for the Development of a Telemedicine System in Palliative Care*. Palliative Medicine and Hospice Care, 2017.

Events and workshops

Replication Games, Berlin 2025.

Participated as replicator

Alumni-Verein Dortmunder Statistikerinnen und Statistiker e.V., Dortmund 2025.

Workshop instructor: *Bayesian Data Analysis with brms*

DAGStat, Berlin 2025.

Workshop instructor: *Bayesian Data Analysis with brms*

Bayesian Methods for the Social Sciences II, Amsterdam 2024.

Poster: *Categories without enough observations? Merge levels at inference time with Bayes!*

ISBA World Meeting, Venice 2024.

Poster: *This Underrated Technique Might Be The Future of Structural Equation Models*

10th IAS Conference on HIV Science, Mexico DF 2019.

Contributed to poster: *Understanding gay couples: a new vision for HIV prevention in Peru*

VI Latin American Meeting on Bayesian Statistics, Lima 2019.

Poster: *Approaches to Model Specification for Regression Analysis with Correlated, Endpoint-Inflated Bounded Count Data*

As attendee: Bayes@Lund 2024, Introduction to Julia for High Performance Computing 2023, Workshop on Informative Prior Elicitation Using Historical Data (ISBA 2024), BayesComp 2023.

Review activity

ASTA Advances in Statistical Analysis. 2025: 1 review.

Psychological Science. 2025: 1 review (as statistical expert).

Teaching

TU Dortmund, Department of Statistics (Course instructor, 2023 – 2025)

Multilevel Modeling Seminar, Introduction to Julia, Intensive Statistics Course

Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú (Teaching assistant, 2017)

Introduction to Statistics, Advanced Regression Techniques

Universidad Peruana Cayetano Heredia (Teaching assistant, 2015 – 2016)

Biostatistics, Epidemiology, Thesis Seminar

Supervision

Ashraf Ahmadian, Master's thesis. Topic: Amortized Inference for Structural Equation Models.

Timo Stenz, student assistant. Implementation of support for variational inference in the **SBC** R package.

Other activities

Lesson Maintainer for The Software Carpentries. Lesson: Version Control with Git (Spanish version).

Skills

Programming	R (tidyverse, targets, brms, shiny), Julia (Tidier, Turing), Python (NumPy, BayesFlow)
Statistics	Hierarchical models, latent variables, Bayesian inference, simulation studies
Tools	SQL, git/GitHub, $\text{\LaTeX}$, SLURM (HPC), Tableau, PowerBI
Languages	Spanish (native), English (fluent), German (basic)